

**Laws and Customs of the Shofar – al-pi Minhag Chabad**  
Prepared for the י"ז אלול ה'תשס"ט Miami Beach, Florida כינוס השלוחים איזורי

**Laws and Chabad Minhagim regarding the שופר**

1. This year the first day of ר"ה is on שבת קודש. We do not blow שופר, nor is it carried.
2. During שבת the שופר is מוקצה. One should remember to bring the שופר to Shul before Yom Tov.
3. This year the שופר will be heard on the second day of ר"ה. (There will be no need for a new fruit or garment)
4. The שופר shape should be bent, although a straight one is also kosher. It must be seen through the hand
5. The שופר should be shown to a competent רב to ensure that it is kosher.
6. We do not eat or drink until we hear תקיעת שופר.
7. The תקיעת שופר takes place on the בימה where the תורה is read.
8. At the Rebbe, the ספרי תורה were held during תקיעת שופר.
9. The Rabbeim had various customs regarding שופר:
  1. The Alter Rebbe (and the Mittler Rebbe) did not blow the שופר.
  2. The custom of the Tzemach Tzedek was not verified.
  3. The Rebbe מהר"ש did blow שופר himself.
  4. The Rebbe Rashab, beginning in תר"ס blew שופר himself.
  5. The Frier-dike Rebbe blew שופר during his נשיאות.
  6. After the first years of נשיאות the Rebbe blew Shofar every year.
  7. Even during the year of availus (ר"ל), the Rabbeim blew שופר and recited שהחיינו.
10. יבין עצמו לתקוע בשופר: The Rebbe writes that the הכנה כללית that is done prior to תקיעת שופר is a preparation for the הכנה לעבודת ה' לכל השנה כולה.
11. The Rabbeim instructed to learn the מאמר found in the Alter Rebbes Siddur entitled שופר תקיעת.
12. The שופר is heard after the Haftarah is read before מוסף.
13. The שופר is kept covered before it is being used. By the Rebbe one could notice the tip of the שופר mouth slightly exposed under the cover.
14. The Rebbe would recite out-loud the first פסוק of למנצה followed by everyone saying it seven times.
15. The eight פסוקים before תקיעת שופר were recited by the Rebbe followed by everyone.
16. The יהי רצון is recited silently by everyone.
17. The Rebbe would place his hand on the covered שופר while he made the ברכות.

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18. The תוקע should have in mind to be יוצא all those who are present.
1. Those listening should also have in mind to be יוצא with saying אמן.
  2. All those listening should hear the תקיעות and follow along in the siddur.
  3. An announcement should be made that one should answer אמן but not שמו ברוך הוא וברוך שמו.
  4. It is preferable not to be מפסיק from before the ברכות until after מוסף has ended.
19. Two ברכות are said by the תוקע:
1. אקב"ו לשמוע קול שופר
  2. שהחיינו
20. The מקריא stands on the right of the תוקע and points to the place in the siddur but does not announce it verbally. This is not done during the תקיעות מעומד.
21. The שופר is placed on the right side of the mouth with the wide part facing heavenward.
22. The תקיעות מיושב consists of 30 sounds of the שופר:
1. תשר"ת – twelve sounds. Care should be taken that The
  2. תש"ת – nine sounds.
  3. תר"ת – nine sounds.
23. The תקיעה consist of one long sound without any break. The minimum שיעור of the תקיעה should not be shorter than a שברים. The length of the תקיעה should be as long as the sounds of the תרועה-שברים, the שברים, or the תרועה.
24. The שברים consists of 3 sound and a short 4<sup>th</sup> sound. We do not add to the שברים any additional sounds.
25. The תרועה consists of many staccato sounds. The minimum sounds of the תרועה are 9 small sounds. One can add as many as one can, as long as it in one breath. The תרועה of Rabbeim were as long as 72 sounds.
26. The Rebbe once said that although the Alter Rebbe rules (ס' תק"ע, ט) that the שברים and תרועה of the תורה should be done in one breath, nevertheless the Rebbe רש"ב did take a breath between them.
27. יתודה בלחש does not mean verbally.
28. If the תוקע has trouble with a certain sound he can repeat that sound until he makes the correct sound.
29. If the תוקע makes a mistake with a sound (i.e. he blew a תרועה instead of a שברים), he should restart the

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line where he has erred.

30. If the תוקע has trouble and is not able to finish, another person replaces him. The new תוקע
1. Should restart the line where the previous person left off.
  2. Does NOT recite the ברכות again.
31. After the תקיעות the Rebbe would recite the 3 פסוקים followed by everyone.
1. Ashrei was recited, and the Rebbe would follow the ספרי תורה back to the ארון קודש.
  2. Afterward, the Rebbe would go up to his place and turn around to see and be seen by everyone.
32. During the silent Amidah of מוסף the תקיעות מעומד consists of 30 תקיעות; A set of תשר"ת תש"ת תר"ת after each of שופרות, מלכיות, and זכרונות.
1. The Gabbai should bang on the table indicating that the תקיעות will begin.
  2. We should stop davening and listen to the שופר.
  3. Afterward we continue davening where we were holding.
33. During the Chazzan's repetition of the מוסף Amidah, the תקיעות מעומד consists of 30 תקיעות; A set of תשר"ת תש"ת תר"ת after each of שופרות, מלכיות, and זכרונות.
1. Although we may sit for חזרת הש"ץ, we stand for the תקיעות.
34. During קדיש תתקבל we blow a final set of תשר"ת תש"ת תר"ת, bringing the total to 100 תקיעות.
35. After תהלים, our custom is to hear an additional 30 תקיעות. The order is the same set of the מיושב.